Name: _____ **Group:** _____ **Date:** _____

4 ESO · SEASONS & CELEBRATIONS · ROUTE PLUS

Learning Path 2 · Celebrations around the world

✏️ Paper worksheet: do the same activities as on the computer. Write your answers and circle the letter of the right option. Do it without notes the first time.

🎯 My goal

Before you start: think about your last recall or checkpoint. What do you want to get better at in this Learning Path?

_____

1 Recall: Getting started

Type the answers without looking. Trying to remember is what helps you learn.

1. In winter the days get _____.
2. The Catalan sweets with almonds and pine nuts: _____
3. Not hot, not cold: _____
4. The US word for autumn: _____
5. In autumn, leaves _____ colour.
6. How do you feel before a party you love? I feel _____.
7. The clocks go _____ in October.
8. It's _____ today. Wear a jumper.

2 Celebration vocabulary

Explore each expression, practise with the cards and complete the sentences.

English	Català	Example
Celebrations		
celebration	celebració	It's a family celebration.
festival	festival, festa	Diwali is a festival of lights.
holiday	festiu, vacances	Christmas is a holiday.
★ tradition	tradició	It's an old tradition.
★ custom	costum	Eating grapes is a New Year custom.
party	festa	We have a party at home.
parade	desfilada	There's a parade in the street.
fireworks	focs artificials	We watch the fireworks.
lights	llums	The streets are full of lights.
candles	espelmes	We light candles.
decorations	decoració	We put up decorations.
present / gift	regal	I get a present.

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English	Català	Example
costume	disfressa	She wears a witch costume.
mask	màscara	He wears a mask.
card	postal, targeta	I send a card to my aunt.
special meal	àpat especial	We have a special meal.
guests	convidats	We have ten guests.
relatives	familiars, parents	We visit our relatives.
Celebration verbs		
★ **celebrate**	celebrar	We celebrate it every year.
decorate	decorar	We decorate the house.
dress up	disfressar-se, mudar-se	Children dress up.
give / get presents	fer / rebre regals	We give presents at Christmas.
sing	cantar	We sing songs.
dance	ballar	People dance in the square.
cook	cuinar	My dad cooks a special meal.
eat together	menjar junts	The family eats together.
visit relatives	visitar familiars	We visit relatives in Girona.
light candles	encendre espelmes	They light candles every night.
wear special clothes	portar roba especial	People wear special clothes.
Traditions (Core)		
gather	reunir-se	People gather in the square.
get together	reunir-se, trobar-se	Families get together.
★ **take part in**	participar en	I take part in the parade.
★ **look forward to**	tenir ganes de	I look forward to the holidays.
★ **pass down**	transmetre (de generació en generació)	Recipes are passed down.
★ **mark an occasion**	commemorar una ocasió	Fireworks mark the occasion.
share a meal	compartir un àpat	We share a meal.
★ **exchange gifts**	intercanviar regals	Families exchange gifts.
make a wish	demanar un desig	Make a wish!
wish someone a happy…	desitjar un feliç… a algú	We wish everyone a happy new year.
Adjectives (Core)		
★ **meaningful**	significatiu	It’s a meaningful day.
traditional	tradicional	A traditional dance.
★ **religious**	religiós	A religious festival.
★ **secular**	laic, no religiós	A secular holiday.
local	local	A local festival.
worldwide	mundial	It’s celebrated worldwide.
family-friendly	per a tota la família	A family-friendly event.
colourful	colorit	Colourful decorations.
crowded	ple de gent	The streets are crowded.

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English	Català	Example
festive	festiu	A festive atmosphere.
Meaning & identity (Plus)		
★ **belonging**	pertinença	A sense of belonging.
★ **heritage**	patrimoni, herència cultural	Our cultural heritage.
★ **roots**	arrels	It reminds us of our roots.
★ **community**	comunitat	The whole community takes part.
★ **ritual**	ritual	Lighting candles is a ritual.
★ **gratitude**	gratitud	A day of gratitude.
★ **commemorate**	commemorar	It commemorates an old story.
★ **honour the dead / ancestors**	honorar els morts / avantpassats	People honour their ancestors.
sacred	sagrat	A sacred place.
★ **the festive season**	les festes (de Nadal)	Shops are busy in the festive season.

★ Key words: learn them by heart. Cover the English column, read the Catalan and say or write the English word.

Review too (earlier Learning Paths): the days get shorter · chestnuts · mild · harvest · the clocks go back · cosy

Words you will hear or read (no need to learn them): menorah · diyas (oil lamps) · lanterns · reunion dinner · Advent calendar · Caga Tió

Study them: cover the English column and say each word in English. Then complete the sentences without looking at the table.

Complete the sentences

1. At Diwali people _____ small oil lamps.
2. Children _____ up as witches and ghosts.
3. There are _____ in the sky at midnight.
4. On Sunday we _____ our relatives in Girona.
5. People walk through the streets in a big _____.
6. Families _____ gifts at Diwali.
7. I always look _____ to the holidays.
8. Christmas is a _____ holiday for some families and a secular one for others.
9. Many families _____ their ancestors on All Saints' Day.
10. Celebrations give people a sense of _____ to a community.

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3 Reading: Four celebrations, four seasons

Read once to see which celebrations it describes. Then find the sentence that answers each question.

Diwali. Diwali, which is known as the festival of lights, is celebrated by Hindus, Sikhs and Jains in October or November, and it lasts five days. Its date depends on the moon, so it changes every year. Before the festival, homes are cleaned and decorated, small oil lamps called diyas are lit, and colourful patterns called rangoli are made on the floor. Families visit relatives, exchange gifts and share sweets, and in many cities the night sky is filled with fireworks. For many people, the lights represent the victory of good over evil and of light over darkness. Today Diwali is also celebrated far from India: in Leicester, in the UK, tens of thousands of people join the street celebrations every year.

Hanukkah. Hanukkah, which is a Jewish festival, usually takes place in December and lasts eight nights. According to Jewish tradition, it remembers an old story in which a small amount of oil burned for eight days in the Temple in Jerusalem. That is why one more candle is lit on the menorah every night, until eight candles are burning on the last night, and why food cooked in oil, such as potato pancakes (latkes) and doughnuts, is eaten. Children play with a dreidel, a spinning top with Hebrew letters on it.

Lunar New Year. Lunar New Year is celebrated in China, Vietnam, Korea and many other places in late January or February, when a new year begins in the lunar calendar. Before the festival, houses are cleaned to sweep away bad luck. On New Year's Eve, families get together for a big reunion dinner, and millions of people travel home, which makes it one of the busiest travel periods in the world. The streets are decorated with red lanterns, because red is associated with good luck, and there are parades with dragon and lion dances. Children are given red envelopes with money.

Castanyada. In Catalonia, the Castanyada is held on 31 October, the night before All Saints' Day. Families and friends get together to roast chestnuts and sweet potatoes and eat panellets, which are small sweets made with almonds and pine nuts. In some schools, a student dresses up as a castanyera, an old woman who sells chestnuts in the street. Although Halloween has become popular among young people, many families keep the tradition alive.

1. How long does Hanukkah last?
   a) five days **b)** one week **c)** eight nights
2. What are diyas?
   a) small oil lamps **b)** sweets **c)** patterns on the floor
3. When is Lunar New Year celebrated?
   a) in October or November **b)** in late January or February **c)** in December
4. Why do people clean their houses before Lunar New Year?
   a) to sweep away bad luck **b)** because it's spring **c)** because guests are coming
5. What do people eat at the Castanyada?
   a) chestnuts, sweet potatoes and panellets **b)** red envelopes **c)** potato pancakes and doughnuts
6. Which celebration has a game with a spinning top?
   a) Diwali **b)** Castanyada **c)** Hanukkah
7. Which two celebrations use lights or candles as a main symbol?
   a) Lunar New Year and Castanyada **b)** Hanukkah and Castanyada **c)** Diwali and Hanukkah
8. In the text, "get together" means…
   a) become friends **b)** meet as a group **c)** travel abroad

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9. For many people, what do the lights of Diwali represent?
   a) the start of winter **b)** good winning over evil **c)** a family's wealth
10. Notice the form: "Lunar New Year ___ in China…"
    a) celebrates **b)** is celebrating **c)** is celebrated
11. Why is food cooked in oil eaten at Hanukkah?
    a) because doughnuts are a symbol of light **b)** because oil is cheap in December
    c) because of an old story about oil that burned for eight days

4 Reading log: two celebrations

*Read the text again and log **two of the four celebrations** (you choose). Write short notes in your own words, not copied sentences.*

Model (Hanukkah): Jewish festival · December · eight nights · at home, with the family
Customs: one more candle every night · food cooked in oil
Word: *menorah* = a candle holder. Clue: "families light one more candle on a menorah".

Text 1: which celebration? What is it, when and where?

Text 1: the main customs (2–3)

Text 2: which celebration? What is it, when and where?

Text 2: the main customs (2–3)

Word 1 you worked out from context: the word, what it means and the clue in the text

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Word 2 you worked out from context: the word, what it means and the clue in the text

Why does one of these customs matter to the people who celebrate it? (The text does not say it directly: explain how you know.)

Self-assessment

Circle: 1 Not yet · 2 Partly · 3 Mostly · 4 Fully

My notes are short and in my own words	**1 · 2 · 3 · 4**
I chose the main customs, not small details	**1 · 2 · 3 · 4**
I worked out two words from context and can explain the clue	**1 · 2 · 3 · 4**

5 Real listening: Happy Diwali

A real BBC video (British Council). Watch once for the general idea and again for the details. You don't need every word.

🎧 **Happy Diwali** · YouTube video: your teacher will play it for you (youtube.com/watch?v=kjIPGD_WcEY).

1. How long is Diwali?
   a) eight nights **b)** one day **c)** five days
2. Who celebrates Diwali?
   a) Hindus, Sikhs and Jains **b)** only children **c)** only people in the UK
3. Diwali is a festival of…
   a) water **b)** flowers **c)** lights
4. Which UK city has very big Diwali celebrations?
   a) Manchester **b)** Edinburgh **c)** Leicester
5. Which of these do people do at Diwali?
   a) go trick or treating **b)** carve pumpkins **c)** light lamps and watch fireworks
6. What does Diwali celebrate, according to the video?
   a) the end of the school year **b)** the harvest of apples **c)** good over evil and light over darkness
7. Which idea from the video also appears in the reading text?
   a) Families share food and exchange gifts. **b)** Children get red envelopes.
   c) People play with a dreidel.

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6 Present Simple for customs · on / in / at

Read how it works and complete the sentences. After two wrong tries you will see the answer.

How it works

We use the **Present Simple** for customs that happen every year: *People decorate their houses. Children dress up. We don't work on 25 December.*

Useful chunks: *It is celebrated on… · It takes place in… · It is held in…*

on + date or day (*on 31 October, on New Year's Eve*) · **in** + month or season (*in November, in winter*) · **at** + festival time or night (*at Christmas, at night*).

Present Simple passive (am / is / are + past participle) to focus on the custom, not the people: *Pumpkins are carved. Gifts are exchanged at midnight.*

1. Children _____ (dress) up at Halloween.
2. My grandmother _____ (cook) a special meal every year.
3. We _____ (not / go) to school on 25 December.
4. The Castanyada is held _____ 31 October.
5. Diwali takes place _____ autumn.
6. We visit our relatives _____ Christmas.
7. People light candles _____ night.
8. Lunar New Year _____ celebrated in late January or February.
9. _____ your family decorate the house? — Yes, it does.
10. Hanukkah _____ (last) eight nights.
11. Families _____ (exchange) gifts at Diwali.
12. Lunar New Year _____ place in late January or February.
13. People carve pumpkins. → Pumpkins _____ _____.
14. People exchange gifts at midnight. → Gifts _____ _____ at midnight.
15. They don't sell chestnuts in summer. → Chestnuts _____ _____ _____ in summer.

7 Mixed practice (LS1 + LS2)

New and LS1 language mixed: first decide which form you need.

1. The parade starts _____ ten o'clock.
2. My family _____ (eat) together at Christmas.
3. Hanukkah is _____ December.
4. We _____ (sing) songs at Christmas.
5. The fireworks are _____ night.
6. My cousins _____ always late for the special meal.
7. _____ Diwali last five days?
8. We _____ (never / work) on 1 January.

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9. We look forward _____ the holidays all year.

10. My uncle picks up the presents. → My uncle picks _____ _____.

11. Lanterns _____ _____ (hang) in the streets.

8 Piece 1: describe a celebration for a visitor

This text is the first piece of your final product.

Your task

Describe a celebration for a visitor who doesn't know it (120–150 words): what, when, customs, food or symbols, what it means to people (heritage, belonging, commemorate…) and at least two Present Simple passives.

Model (don't copy it)

Sant Joan is celebrated on the night of 23 June. People light bonfires and there are fireworks. Families and friends get together for a special meal and eat coca. Young people stay up very late. I feel excited because it is the start of summer.

Pauta: ___ is celebrated on / in ___. People ___. Children ___. Families ___. We eat ___. I feel ___ because ___.

Minimum 120 words.

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Check before you hand it in

☐ Present Simple for customs

☐ What it means to people (meaning words)

☐ Two Present Simple passives

☐ Linked, varied sentences

9 Speaking: a visitor asks you

Record your explanation of the same celebration. Use notes; don't read your text.

Your task

Explain your celebration to a visitor (90–120 s), including its meaning, and answer: Why is it important to you?

Model

The Castanyada, a local celebration, is held on 31 October, the night before All Saints' Day. Chestnuts are roasted and panellets are shared. For many families it is about belonging and honouring older generations, so it matters to me because it connects me to my roots.

Write what you will say · Then read it aloud three times and say it to your teacher.

🔁 How did it go?

What helped me most?

What do I need to review?

📚 Study guide: prepare for Checkpoint 1 and the final exam

How to study what you learn in this Learning Path, and practice that works like the checkpoint and looks like the exam. The answer key is at the end of each activity.

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How to study

🧠 Test yourself, don't reread

Close your notes and try to remember: write the words, say the rule, answer the questions. Then check. Rereading and highlighting feel useful, but you remember much less.

Retrieval practice · Roediger & Karpicke 2006; Dunlosky et al. 2013

📅 Spread it out

Three short sessions of 15 minutes on different days work better than one long session the day before.

Spacing · Cepeda et al. 2006

🔀 Mix it up

Practise similar things together so you learn to choose the right one for each sentence.

Interleaving · Rohrer & Taylor 2007

✅ Check and fix at once

Mark your answers with the key straight away and write each wrong answer again, correctly.

Feedback · Hattie & Timperley 2007

💬 Say why

For every answer, say the reason: "on, because it's a date." Explaining makes the rule stick.

Self-explanation · Dunlosky et al. 2013

😴 Sleep on it

Your brain stores what you learn while you sleep. A short self-test and a good night's sleep beat studying late the night before.

Sleep and memory · Diekelmann & Born 2010

My plan

1. **Today** · Close this page and write from memory: five celebration words and two customs with on / in / at. Then check.
2. **In 2–3 days** · Do "Practise for Checkpoint 1" below. Look at the key and write again what you got wrong.
3. **Before Checkpoint 1** · Go over the flashcards: only the ones you still miss.
4. **The week before the exam** · Do the exam-style practice in every Learning Path, then the Sample exam. Repeat only the parts you failed.

What comes up

Checkpoint 1 (LS1 and Learning Paths 1 and 2): short gaps, one question at a time, about 45 seconds each, no going back and no notes. You do it once, and you must stay on the page: if you leave it, it is sent. It opens the next Learning Path.
Final exam: this Learning Path comes up in the Vocabulary (celebrations and customs) and in the Grammar (Present Simple for customs, on / in / at, and the passive for Plus).

Practise for Checkpoint 1

One question at a time · 45 s

It works like the real checkpoint: 13 questions, one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back and no notes. This is only practice: nothing is sent, you can repeat it, and at the end you see your answers and the key.

On paper: cover the questions and uncover them one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back.

1. At Diwali, people light small oil _____.
2. Families _____ (visit) their relatives at Christmas.

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3. Sant Jordi is _____ 23 April.
4. In winter it's _____: take a coat.
5. Children dress _____ at Carnival.
6. We watch the _____ in the sky at New Year: bang, bang!
7. My aunt _____ (make) panellets every year.
8. We don't go to school _____ Christmas Day.
9. Many families get _____ for a big meal at Christmas.
10. Hundreds of people take part _____ the parade.
11. Grandparents pass _____ old recipes to their grandchildren.
12. Panellets _____ _____ (make) with almonds and pine nuts.
13. A _____ celebration is not religious.

Like the exam: Vocabulary 1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right word, or type it.

1. At Carnival, people wear a ___. [1 point]
a) candle **b)** costume **c)** relative **d)** present

2. The ___ goes down the main street with music and dancers. [1 point]
a) gift **b)** tradition **c)** candle **d)** parade

3. My cousins, aunts and uncles are my ___. [1 point]
a) relatives **b)** customs **c)** fireworks **d)** decorations

4. We put up ___ in the house before Christmas. [1 point]
a) relatives **b)** meals **c)** decorations **d)** fireworks

5. Diwali and Hanukkah are r_____ festivals: they come from a religion. [2 points]

6. Many people feel a sense of b_____ when the whole town celebrates together. [2 points]

Like the exam: Grammar 1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right form, or type it.

1. People ___ chestnuts at the Castanyada. [1 point]
a) eat **b)** eats **c)** eating **d)** are eat

2. Halloween is ___ 31 October. [1 point]
a) on **b)** at **c)** in **d)** to

3. Families get together ___ New Year. [1 point]
a) in **b)** on **c)** at **d)** to

4. _____ your grandparents cook a special meal? — Yes, they do. [2 points]

5. Sant Joan _____ place on the night of 23 June. [2 points]

6. People light bonfires. → Bonfires _____ _____. [2 points]

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📚 Study guide: answer key

Look at them only when you have finished each activity.

Practise for Checkpoint 1

1. **lamps** · Small oil lamps = diyas.
2. **visit** · Families = they: no -s.
3. **on** · Date → on.
4. **cold** · A coat → it's cold.
5. **up** · dress up = wear a costume.
6. **fireworks** · fireworks = focs artificials.
7. **makes** · She → makes.
8. **on** · A particular day → on.
9. **together** · get together = meet as a group.
10. **in** · take part in.
11. **down** · pass down = give to the next generation.
12. **are made** · Present Simple passive: are + past participle.
13. **secular** · secular = not religious.

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1. **costume** · costume = special clothes to dress up.
2. **parade** · parade = people walking in the street to celebrate.
3. **relatives** · relatives = your family.
4. **decorations** · decorations = things that make a place look special.
5. **religious** · religion → religious.
6. **belonging** · a sense of belonging = feeling part of a group.

Like the exam: Grammar

1. **eat** · People = they: eat.
2. **on** · Date → on.
3. **at** · Festival time → at.
4. **do** · Questions with they: Do…?
5. **takes** · It takes place on + date.
6. **are lit** · Passive: are + past participle (light → lit).

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